BEGINNER GUIDE

Aisle: how the website works

A professional glass storefront where scrolling walks the shopping agent through each step — explained simply, with the code that matters.

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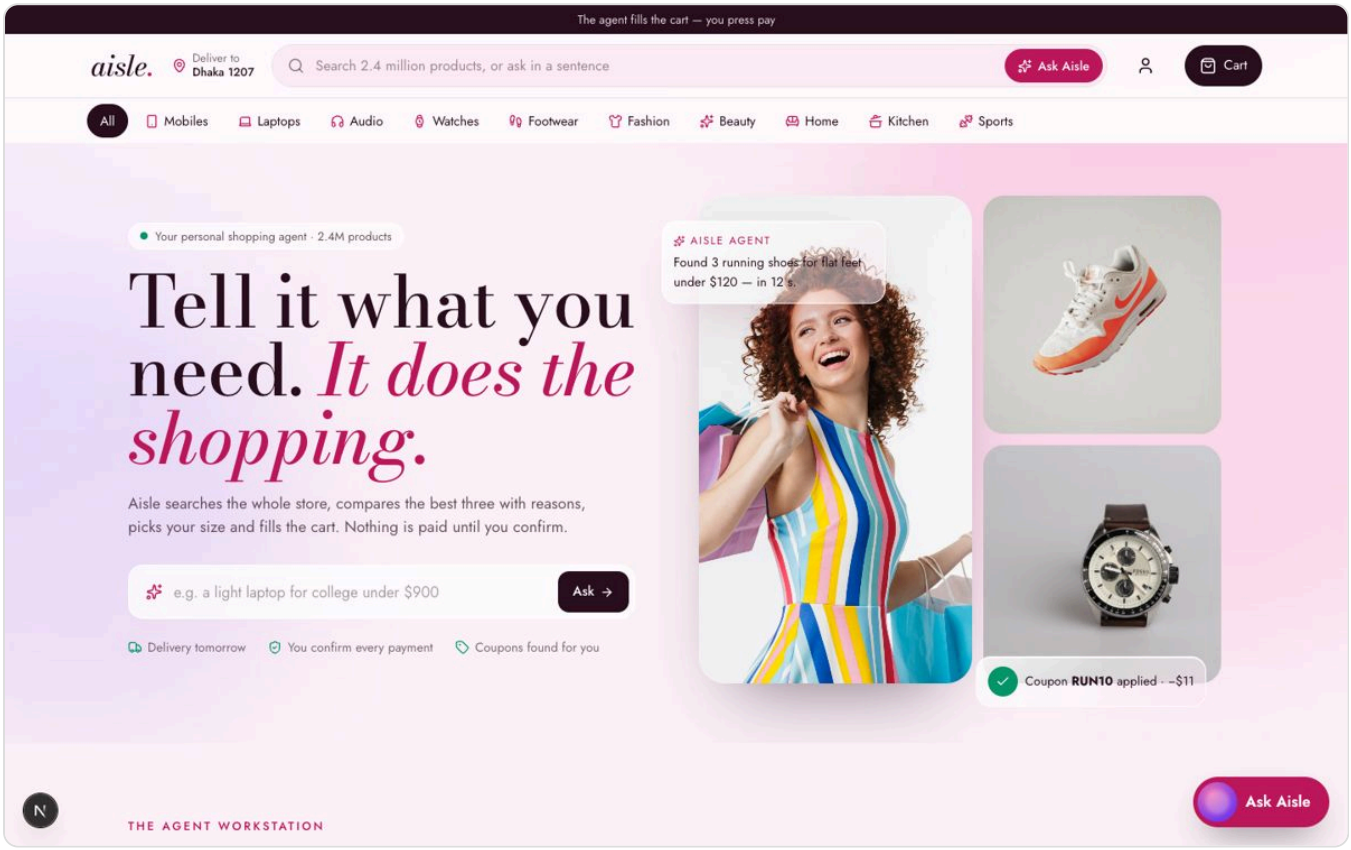
Written for Amartya Ghosh

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01 What you are looking at

Aisle is a website for an imaginary **shopping store with an AI agent**. You tell the agent what you need in one sentence; it searches, compares the best three, fills the cart — and **you** press pay.

The design is **light, glassy and professional**: soft pink background glows, white frosted panels, one berry accent, and real product photos. There is no 3D — the movement comes from scrolling.



The hero: a search box that speaks to the agent, and a photo collage that drifts at different speeds as you scroll.

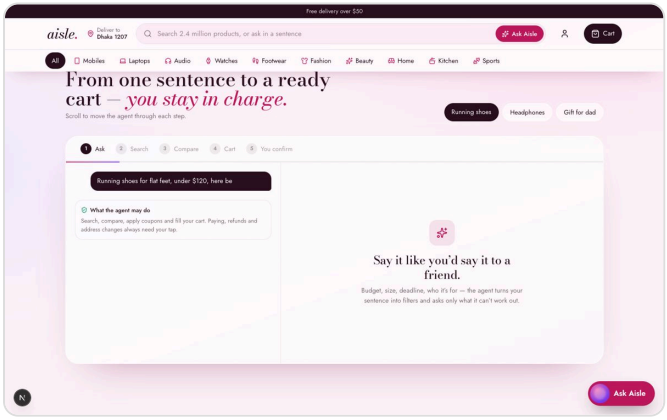
Part of the page	What it does	File
Header	Offer strip, search, cart button, department bar	app/components/shop/Header.tsx
Hero	Headline, ask-box, photo collage with parallax	shop/Storefront.tsx → Hero
Gallery	Three tilted rows of product photos sliding with scroll	Storefront.tsx → Gallery
Agent workstation	Ask → Search → Compare → Cart → You confirm, moved by scroll	Storefront.tsx → AgentDesk
Shelf	Department tabs, one compact row, “View all” drawer	Storefront.tsx → Shelf
Banners	Three photo promos with gentle parallax	Storefront.tsx → Promos
For brands, guardrails, footer	Merchant copilot, rules, credits	app/components/Sections.tsx

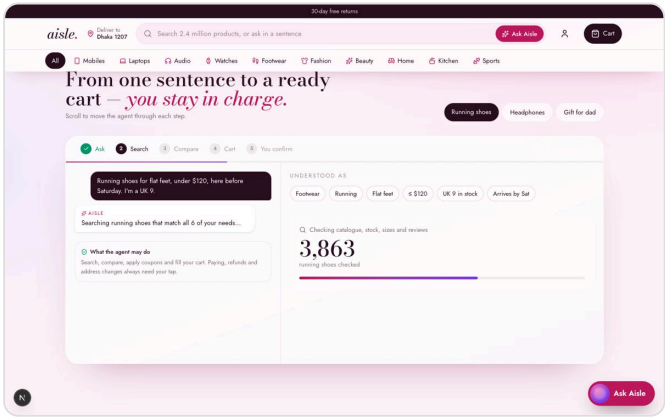
Part of the page	What it does	File
Product sheet + cart drawer	Pop-ups for one product and for the cart	shop/Overlays.tsx
All products	84 products: name, price, photo…	app/data/shop.ts

02 Why it looks professional

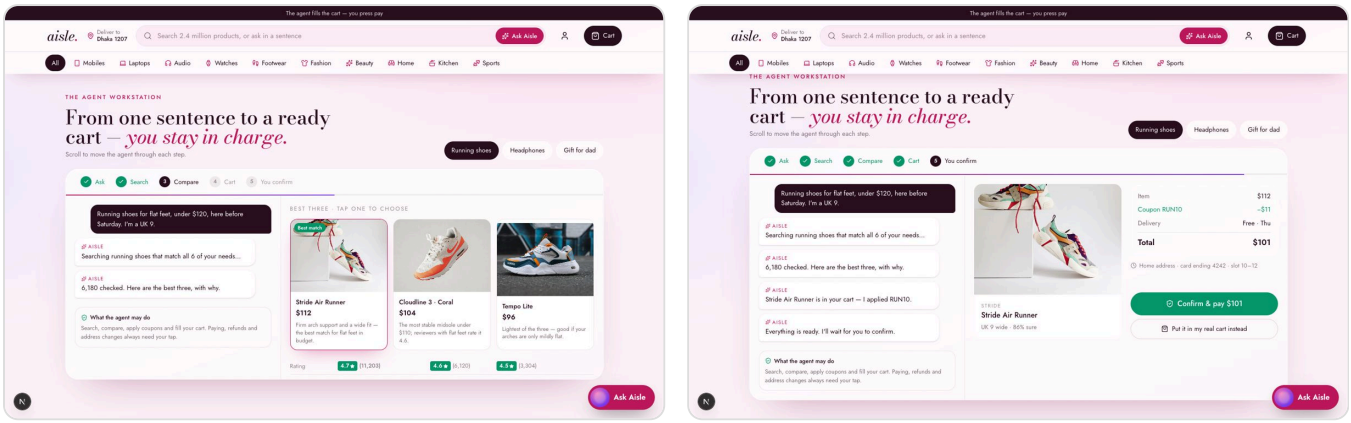
- **Calm palette:** blush background, deep plum text, berry for actions, emerald only for “good / money-safe”. Never more than one loud colour on screen.
- **Two fonts with jobs:** Bodoni Moda (elegant serif, italic for the emphasised words) for headlines; Jost for everything you read and click.
- **Real photos, square and consistent:** every product photo is cropped 800×800 the same way, so rows look tidy like a real shop.
- **No endless scrolling list.** Each department shows one row; “View all” opens a drawer. Visitors stay in control.
- **The agent is the hero, not decoration:** the workstation shows exactly what the agent does and where *you* stay in charge.

03 The agent workstation (scroll moves the steps)





Step 1 — Ask (the request types itself as you scroll). Step 2 — Search (your sentence becomes filters; the counter climbs).



Step 3 — Compare (best three with reasons; tap to choose). Step 5 — You confirm (nothing is paid until you tap).

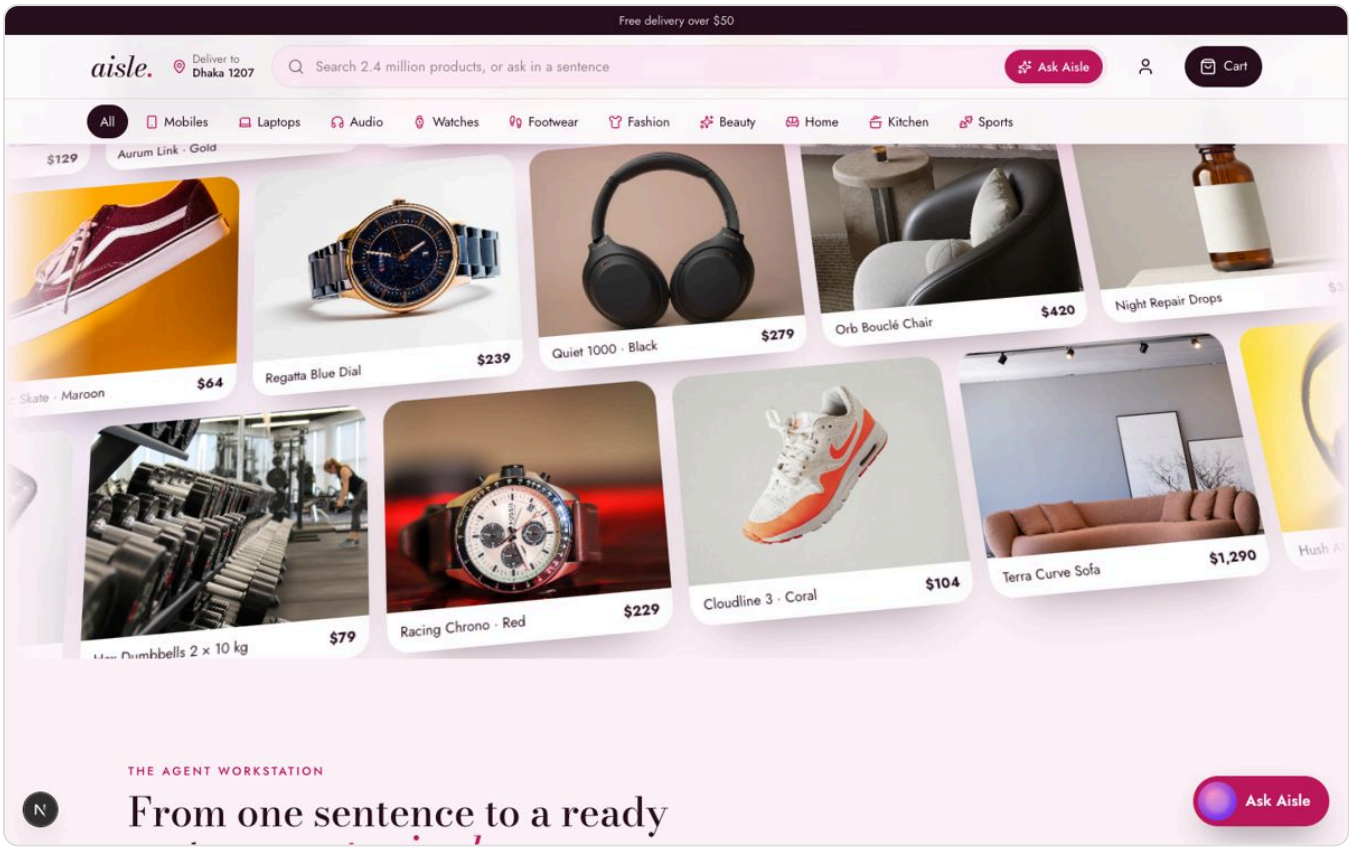
On a laptop the section is **520vh** tall and its content is sticky, so the workstation stays still while you scroll. Scroll progress (0 → 1) is split into **5 steps**. Inside a step, the leftover part (`sub`) drives the small animations:

```
// Storefront.tsx → AgentDesk (simplified)
const x = progress * 5;             // 0 … 5
const step = Math.floor(x);         // 0 Ask, 1 Search, 2 Compare, 3 Cart, 4 Confirm
const sub = x % 1;                  // 0 … 1 inside the step

// Step 0: type the request letter by letter as you scroll
typed = step > 0 ? question.length : Math.round(question.length * sub * 1.3);
// Step 1: the "products checked" counter climbs with the scroll
count = step > 1 ? total : step === 1 ? Math.round(total * sub * 1.25) : 0;
```

- The **chat column** on the left grows with one agent message per step.
- The **stepper** at the top ticks green for finished steps; a thin bar under it fills with the scroll.
- Clicking a step **scrolls the page** to that step, so clicking and scrolling always agree.
- On phones there's no pinning — a **timer** walks through the steps instead.
- Three example requests (shoes, headphones, gift) live in `SCENARIOS` — each has filters, three picks with reasons, and an optional coupon.

04 Things that move with your scroll



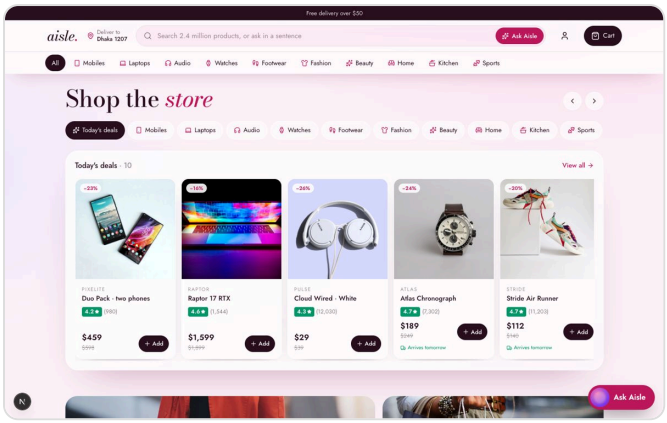
The gallery: three rows of real product photos on a tilted plane, sliding in opposite directions as you scroll.

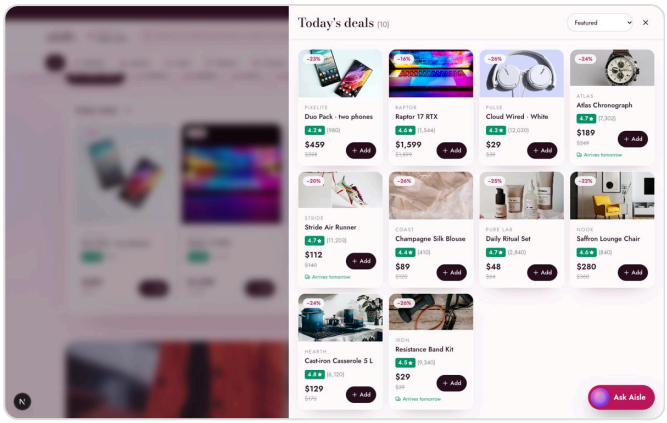
```
// Storefront.tsx → Gallery
const { scrollYProgress } = useScroll({ target: ref, offset: ["start end", "end start"] });
// row 1 slides right, row 2 slides left, row 3 right …
const x = useTransform(scrollYProgress, [0, 1], dir > 0 ? ["-28%", "2%"] : ["2%", "-28%"]);
<motion.div style={{ x }}> …cards… </motion.div>

// the whole block is tilted in 3D with plain CSS:
transform: rotateX(18deg) rotateZ(-5deg) scale(1.08);   // inside a parent with perspective
```

Hero parallax: the big photo moves up 10%, the small ones 20% and 34% as you scroll past. Things that move *more* feel *closer* — that's all parallax is. The promo banners use the same trick inside a frame (the image is 14% bigger than the frame, so it has room to slide).

05 Shelf, drawer and cart





The shelf shows one compact row per department; “View all” opens a drawer with sorting.

- **Shared shop state** (`shop/store.tsx`) holds the cart, the chosen department, the search text and the open product. Any component can use it with `useShop()` .
- The **cart is remembered** in the browser (`localStorage`), so a refresh keeps it.
- The header **search** filters the shelf as you type; the sparkle button sends the sentence to the agent instead.
- **Checkout** is two steps: the agent prepares the order (address, slot, card) → you press “Confirm & pay”. It's a demo, nothing is charged.

06 How to change things

I want to…	Do this
Add a product	Put an 800×800 photo in `public/products/<dept>/` and copy one row in `app/data/shop.ts`
Change prices or names	`app/data/shop.ts`
Add a new example request to the workstation	`Storefront.tsx` → `SCENARIOS` (question, filters, three picks with reasons)
Change which photos fly in the gallery	`Storefront.tsx` → `ROWS` (product ids)
Change the banners	Replace images in `public/banners/` or edit `Promos`
Change colours	`app/globals.css` → `--color-berry` , `--color-plum` , `--color-emerald`
Make the agent steps take more or less scrolling	`h-[520vh]` on the AgentDesk section: bigger = slower

```
cd ~/Downloads/aisle-shopping
npm install          # first time only
npm run dev -- -p 3102
# open http://localhost:3102

# Publish a change: commit and push — Vercel redeploys automatically
git add -A && git commit -m "describe the change" && git push
# live: https://aisle-agentic-store.vercel.app
```

07 Words you'll meet

Word	What it means here
Section / pinned section	A block of the page. *Pinned* (or *sticky*) means it stays on screen while you keep scrolling, so things inside it can animate.
Scroll progress (p)	A number from 0 to 1: how far you are through a section. Almost every animation is just “turn p into a position, size or opacity”.
Component	A reusable piece of a React page, written in a `.tsx` file (e.g. `Hero`, `Workstation`).
State	A value a component remembers (e.g. which tab is open). Changing it redraws that part of the page.
motion	The animation library: `motion.div` is a div that can animate; `useScroll` gives scroll progress; `useTransform` maps it to a value.
Lenis	Smooth scrolling: it makes the wheel feel soft and inertial instead of jumpy.
three.js / WebGL	Real 3D in the browser: a scene, a camera, lights and objects drawn by the graphics card every frame.
Shader (GLSL)	A tiny program that runs on the graphics card for every pixel (or every point) — used for special looks like night lights or glow.
Texture	An image wrapped onto a 3D object (e.g. the Earth's day map).
Glass / glassmorphism	A see-through panel: semi-transparent background + `backdrop-filter: blur()` + a thin bright border.
Tailwind classes	Short style words in `className`, e.g. `rounded-2xl` (round corners), `px-6` (side padding), `text-ink/60` (ink colour at 60%).